The prime minister, in a televised address, expressed sympathy with the people who had lost their loved ones in the second surge of the virus in the country. He assured the people that the government was doing all that was possible to ensure that beds, oxygen and medical supplies were made available to meet the rising demands. He announced that vaccination would open up for folks over the age of 18 from 1 May which would likely contribute to resumption of economic activities. He specified that while his government was working to save every life possible, they also had to ensure that economic activities functioned smoothly. For that, he requested states to enforce strict lockdowns and close up economic activities as a final resort in the fight against the virus.[40]

During his speech, his facial expressions gave away the exhaustion that he was experiencing ramping up resources from every corner of the country to make ends meet for the people. Over the next couple of weeks as part of his outreach efforts to various contributing groups of people, the prime minister held meetings with leaders of the pharmaceutical industry[41], vaccine manufacturers, industrial producers of oxygen[42] and the nation's leading doctors seeking their cooperation to combat the wave; this was in addition to his regular review meetings with senior officials of the government and the Indian forces. To each of the attendees in these meetings, apart from showing deep gratitude for their contribution, he cross-checked current status, urged them to do the best they could and promised government assistance from the top. A close aide of the prime minister who was part of most meetings in the PMO during the second wave would later say,

> The prime minister is resolute. He would take continuous meetings during the second wave, one after the other, trying to get on top of issues as quickly as possible, tirelessly. But even for me, just being present in one strenuous meeting after the other, encountering one challenge after the other and going out of our way to find immediate solutions was mentally draining. So, imagine how the prime minister must have felt knowing that 1.3 billion lives depended on him! He isn't someone who gets bogged down though, always ready to take a challenge head-on.

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